

signing work to be done, etc. The public keys are public knowledge anyway, so they're all published in the log of events that any of us can access, and we can watch the ceremony live as well.

The ceremony and participants and format are all decided on in such a way

so as to reduce the risk of someone corrupt undermining the system. With the way it is set up right now, it is estimated that there is less than 1 in a million chance of even a group of conspirators, all of whom are involved with this procedure, to be successful.

Currently there are no crypto officers from India, sadly, but there is one from Nepal and one from Mauritius. If you currently work in a large web company, with DNS servers, nominate yourself for the role at iana.org – we need some representation. **4**

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All of us have at some point in life bought a domain, or wanted to buy a domain. Whether it was to set up a blog, or host some personal stuff, or even an internet address for a private business (if you run one). Getting a domain that is short is next to impossible now, given that so many people jump to buy up domain names and then try to sell them at profit. Called domain squatters, these people are the lowest form of scum on the earth. Has this writer had some negative experiences with a domain squatter? How did you guess?

However, have you considered this... how often do you pay for the same loaf of bread? A bottle of milk? Do you have to keep going back and paying every year (or two or 5 or 10) for the new shoes you just bought? Domain names are not like anything that you can buy, and it's not like anything that you buy on EMIs either... while you can buy a house

rid of tenants, and is well within his legal rights to do so, as the property belongs to him. It's a weird owner-less lease – it's a lot like the colonisation of a new world, for example. No one owns land in the new world, so people just claim what they want as theirs, and then set up an authority to legalise those claims. And since authorities need money to function, they use a lease format to ensure money keeps flowing in from you, but in small amounts that most people can afford. Stop paying for your lease, and they will warn you that you will lose access to your land, and if you don't listen, and don't pay, that land is transferred to someone else willing to pay the fee, on a first come first serve basis. Exceptions are made sometimes, for example, if the property is called digit.in, and it is leased by a squatter, we could file a case of arbitration to the Indian Registry for Internet Names and Numbers (www.irinn.in/) and claim that they are infringing on our trademarked name, and then wrestle control of the domain away from the squatter (after paying whatever they spent on the domain of course).

The IRINN is recognised by the Government of India, Department of Electronics & Information Technology (meity.gov.in) and its guidelines are set in accordance with international norms, but conforming to the laws of India. For example, in the US pornography is not illegal, but in India it is, and thus, if someone was using a .in domain for pornography, a complainant could get the domain banned or blocked, and perhaps even make a legal case for taking over the domain.

The bottom line is that on the internet, you don't really "own" anything. Even services can delete your account without fear of legal ramifications, because it is all built into the terms of use service agreements that none of us read. The same goes for domains, and this is why you should be aware of your rights and obligations – not just to protect yourself and the domains you own, but also because you might find

that a domain name that is associated with you or your business is already registered to someone else, but that doesn't mean you cannot try and get ownership of it, especially if they're flouting the rules of the land. Take some time to read through everything available on the IRINN site, registry.in and the nxi.in sites, and educate yourself about your rights. **4**

on EMIs and pay every month, a rich person could buy the same house outright and then never make another payment. Same for cars. Same for just about anything you buy.

Thus, you don't really "buy" a domain, you lease it. Use the domain to do something illegal, and you automatically lose the rights to the domain. If someone else is willing to fight through courts and/or arbitration by the domain authorities, then you can even lose a domain name that you bought legally. This is why you can't say bought, but have to say leased.

Of course the lease is subject to the laws of the country, and a domain registrar or domain authority cannot arbitrarily remove your access to a domain you leased. This is not like a landlord who wants to get

all about TLDs

Who really
owns domains?

